

PeelPanel — Peel-And-Stick Solar Film

Solar that installs like a sticker.

What It Is

A business selling thin, flexible peel-and-stick solar film — a lightweight photovoltaic sheet that adheres to almost any surface with no drilling, racks, or heavy installation crew. Pioneered in Germany, it works where traditional rigid panels never could: curved roofs, old buildings, warehouses, RVs, boats, and vehicles. That opens a massive market of surfaces nobody could ever put solar on before — and if nobody's selling it where you live yet, you can be first in your whole country.

How It Makes Money

You import flexible solar film and sell it through three channels: direct-to-consumer e-commerce (RV/van-life/boat owners, off-grid hobbyists), B2B to installers and warehouse/fleet operators, and a done-for-you supply-and-fit service at a premium. Recurring revenue comes from being the regional distributor/installer brand. Margins are strong because the product is novel, high-value, and most markets have no local supplier.

Startup Costs

- Initial inventory (flexible solar film + adhesive + connectors): **\$3,000-\$12,000** — Alibaba search "flexible thin film solar panel adhesive ETFE"
- Samples + testing from multiple suppliers: **\$300-\$1,000**
- Shopify/website + product photography: **\$500-\$2,000**
- Charge controllers, cables, inverters (resale kit components): **\$1,000-\$4,000**
- Certifications / electrical compliance (region-dependent): **\$500-\$3,000**
- Marketing / launch ads: **\$1,000-\$3,000**
- Per-unit import note: flexible thin-film panels land around **\$0.40-\$0.90 per watt** from China (a 100W flexible panel ≈ **\$40-\$80** landed), well below installed rigid-panel cost.
- **Total to launch: ~\$6,000-\$25,000**

The Numbers

- Landed cost of a 100W flexible panel: **~\$55**; full kit (panel + controller + cables): **~\$120**
- Sell the 100W kit at **\$220-\$320** → profit **~\$100-\$200/kit**
- Larger jobs (warehouse roof, 5kW flexible array): hardware **~\$3,000-\$5,000**, sell installed at **\$8,000-\$14,000** → profit **\$4,000-\$8,000/job**
- 40 kits/month + 2 install jobs → **\$12,000-\$25,000/month** blended
- Net after ads/logistics: **\$6,000-\$15,000/month**, scaling with installer accounts.

How To Start

1. Order film samples from 2-3 suppliers; verify output, durability, and adhesive quality.
2. Confirm local electrical/import compliance and certifications you'll need.
3. Build a Shopify store + a B2B line targeting RVs, boats, warehouses, and old roofs.

4. Assemble starter kits (panel + controller + cables) for easy DIY customers.
5. Shoot demo content: peeling, sticking, and powering a load on a curved surface.
6. Sell DTC kits online while pitching installers and fleet/warehouse operators on bulk.
7. Add a premium supply-and-fit service for customers who want it done.

Where To Get Customers

- DTC e-commerce + ads targeting van-life, RV, boating, off-grid, prepper niches
- B2B outreach to solar installers, warehouse owners, and fleet operators
- Surfaces rigid panels can't serve: curved roofs, heritage buildings, vehicles
- YouTube/Reels demos of the "peel, stick, power on" moment
- Trade shows and regional "first solar film supplier" PR angle

Pro Tips

- Win the surfaces traditional panels can't touch — curved, lightweight, and load-limited roofs. That's your uncontested market, not competing on flat residential roofs.
- Be the regional first-mover and own the keyword. Being "the peel-and-stick solar company" in your country is a durable brand moat.
- Sell complete kits, not bare film. Bundling controller + cables raises ticket size and removes the buyer's biggest objection — "will it actually work?"